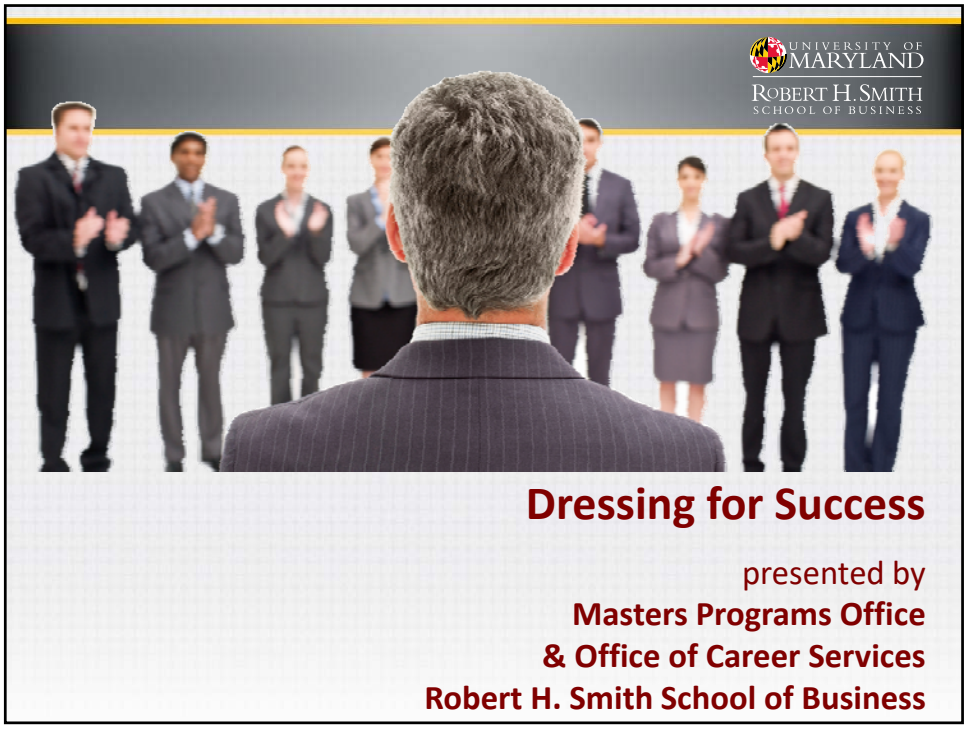

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Dressing for Success
presented by
Masters Programs Office
& Office of Career Services
Robert H. Smith School of Business


"Business Professional"
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## Business Professional: Suits

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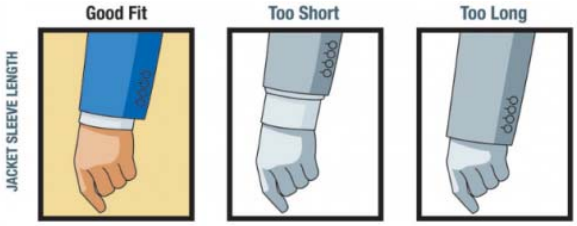
**Success = Dark pant or skirt suit**



## Business Professional: Blouses & Shirts








**Tips:**

- **Solid color or subtle patterns/stripes**
- **Cuffs should be snug**
- **Shirt sleeve should fall a half inch below suit sleeve**

## Business Professional: Shoes/Accessories

**Tips:**

- **Muted jewelry**
- **Match shoes with belt**
- **Tie should fall to the middle of the belt buckle**





## NOT Business Professional

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**A jacket over a party dress ≠ business professional**



**A jacket with trousers ≠ business professional**



## Respecting Diverse Cultures

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**Professional dress can accommodate personal, religious, cultural, and social dress traditions**





## "Business Casual"

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## "Casual"

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## "Black Tie," "Formal," or "Semi-Formal"

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## Importance of Fit

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**Poor Fit** **Good Fit**



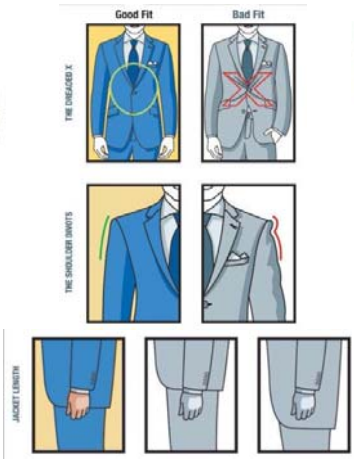
## Fit Tips

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### Shirts




### Suit Jacket




### Pant Length



Too Long



Proper Length

## Fit Tips

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### Suit Jacket



- Jacket sleeves should reach wrist bones
- Shoulder seams don't extend past shoulders

### Skirt Length



- Skirt should fall at or slightly below the knee
- Should not be too tight; avoid puckering

### Pant Length



- Waist should fit comfortably
- Pant hem should be one inch above the floor with tips of heels peeking out

## Importance of Grooming

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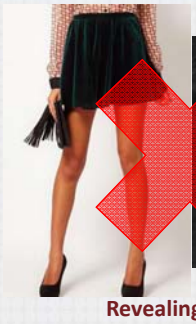


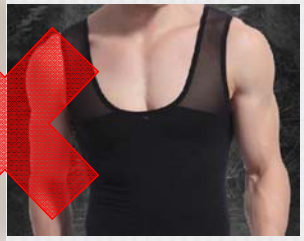
## Always Avoid these Wardrobe Problems

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Stains





Revealing skirts or shirts




Offensive sayings

## Final Tips

- First impressions are critical—choose an appropriate outfit and be well groomed
- Secure at least one high-quality, well-tailored business professional suit
- Pay attention to dress code when receiving event invitations
- Follow stated dress code when attending events; ask about dress code if it's not stated
- It's better to be overdressed than too casual

